



English AI
Local Coach

ENGLISH AI · THEORY LESSON

Doctor & Pharmacy

Vocabulary, useful phrases, grammar, writing and conversation practice

Level A2-B1 · 45-60 min · Lesson 05

LESSON GOAL

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to describe common symptoms, explain how long you have felt unwell, understand basic questions at a clinic, ask for help at a pharmacy, and follow simple medicine instructions in English.

Learn the vocabulary first, then practise the functional phrases and grammar. Finish by opening the Conversation Lab and acting out a doctor appointment and a pharmacy visit.

Important language note

This lesson teaches English for everyday communication. It does not replace medical advice. In real situations, ask a qualified health professional when you are unsure about symptoms or medicines.

[START HERE](#)

Lesson map

A clear sequence: learn the health vocabulary, describe what is happening, understand common questions, and then use the language in realistic conversations.

01

LEARN

Symptoms + body vocabulary

02

BUILD

Grammar + writing

03

SPEAK

Doctor + pharmacy role-play

Warm-up

1. What do you usually do when you feel sick?
2. Is it easy for you to describe pain in English?
3. What health words do you already know in English?
4. Have you ever needed to speak English at a pharmacy or clinic?

Before you continue

Answer the four questions in English with short sentences. Do not worry about perfect grammar yet - the goal is to activate the vocabulary you already know.

VOCABULARY 01

Common symptoms

These are useful words for explaining how you feel at a clinic, pharmacy, hotel reception, airport, or while travelling.

WORD / PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE
headache	dor de cabeça	I have a bad headache.
sore throat	dor de garganta	My throat has been sore since yesterday.
cough	tosse	I have had a cough for three days.
runny nose	coriza / nariz escorrendo	I have a runny nose.
stuffy nose	nariz entupido	My nose is completely stuffy.
fever	febre	I think I have a fever.
chills	calafrios	I had chills last night.
nausea	náusea	I feel nauseous after eating.
dizzy	tonto	I feel dizzy when I stand up.
tired / exhausted	cansado / exausto	I feel extremely tired today.
stomachache	dor de estômago / barriga	I have a stomachache.
back pain	dor nas costas	I have pain in my lower back.
rash	erupção / irritação na pele	I noticed a rash on my arm.
swelling	inchaço	There is some swelling around my ankle.
allergy	alergia	I have an allergy to penicillin.
pain	dor	The pain gets worse when I move.

Vocabulary habit

Do not memorise only “headache” or “cough”. Learn the complete chunks: “I have a headache”, “I have had a cough for three days”, “I feel dizzy”.

VOCABULARY 02

Body, medicine and clinic language

These combinations help you understand basic questions and instructions when you need medical help.

make an appointment - schedule a time to see a doctor

see a doctor - visit a doctor for medical help

describe your symptoms - explain what you are feeling

take your temperature - measure body temperature

check your blood pressure - measure blood pressure

take medicine - use medicine according to instructions

take one tablet - use one pill/tablet as a dose

twice a day - two times every day

with food - together with or after eating

on an empty stomach - without food in your stomach

side effect - an unwanted effect of a medicine

prescription - a medical order for a medicine

over-the-counter medicine - medicine available without a prescription

Notice

In English, we usually say “take medicine”, not “drink medicine” for medicine in general. For liquids, you can say “take this syrup” or “take 10 millilitres”.

Quick practice

Complete: make an _____.

Complete: take one _____.

Complete: twice a _____.

Write one sentence with “side effect”.

USEFUL LANGUAGE

Phrases you can actually use

Organise the phrases by moment: explaining the problem, answering the doctor, asking questions, and speaking at a pharmacy.

DESCRIBING THE PROBLEM

- I do not feel very well.
- I have a headache and a sore throat.
- I feel dizzy and very tired.
- My stomach hurts.

TIME & INTENSITY

- It started yesterday morning.
- I have had this cough for three days.
- The pain is mild / moderate / severe.
- It gets worse at night.

ANSWERING A DOCTOR

- No, I do not have any allergies.
- Yes, I am allergic to penicillin.
- I am not taking any medication at the moment.
- I took some pain medicine this morning.

ASKING QUESTIONS

- What do you think it could be?
- Do I need a prescription?
- How often should I take this?
- Should I take it with food?

AT THE PHARMACY

- Do you have anything for a sore throat?
- I need something for a headache.
- Is this available without a prescription?
- Are there any common side effects?

GRAMMAR

Present perfect for symptoms: have had / have felt

When a symptom started in the past and is still happening now, English often uses the present perfect with “for” or “since”.

PATTERN	EXAMPLE	USE
I have had + symptom	I have had a cough for three days.	the symptom started before now and continues
I have felt + adjective	I have felt tired since Monday.	a feeling or condition continues
for + period	I have had a headache for two hours.	duration: two hours, three days, a week
since + starting point	I have felt sick since yesterday morning.	starting point: Monday, 8 a.m., yesterday
It started + past time	It started last night.	simple way to state the beginning

Natural English

Both forms can be useful: “I have had a headache for two days” focuses on duration. “My headache started two days ago” focuses on when it began.

Mini practice

Complete: I have _____ a cough for three days.

Choose: I have felt tired for / since Monday.

Choose: I have had a fever for / since two hours.

Rewrite: My sore throat started yesterday. → I have _____.

MODEL DIALOGUE

At the doctor

Read once for meaning, then read again and notice how the patient describes symptoms, duration, allergies, and medication.

DOCTOR Hi. What brings you in today?

PATIENT I have had a sore throat and a cough for about three days.

DOCTOR Have you had a fever?

PATIENT I think so. I felt very hot last night and I had chills.

DOCTOR Any headache, nausea, or difficulty breathing?

PATIENT I have a mild headache, but no nausea or breathing problems.

DOCTOR Do you have any allergies to medication?

PATIENT No, I do not.

DOCTOR Are you taking any medication at the moment?

PATIENT Only some pain medicine I took this morning.

DOCTOR Okay. I am going to examine your throat and check your temperature.

PATIENT All right.

DOCTOR After the examination, I will explain what to do next.

PATIENT Thank you. I also wanted to ask how often I should take any medicine you recommend.

Language to steal

“What brings you in today?”, “I have had... for...”, “Do you have any allergies?”, “Are you taking any medication?”, and “How often should I take this?” are highly reusable patterns.

Comprehension

1. How long has the patient been sick?
2. What symptoms does the patient describe?
3. Does the patient report a medication allergy?
4. What does the doctor plan to check?

WRITING PRACTICE 01

Build accurate sentences

Translate the sentences into English using the vocabulary and structures from this lesson.

1. Eu não estou me sentindo muito bem.
2. Eu estou com dor de cabeça e dor de garganta.
3. Eu estou com tosse há três dias.
4. Eu estou me sentindo tonto.
5. A dor piora à noite.
6. Isso começou ontem de manhã.
7. Eu não tenho alergia a medicamentos.
8. Eu sou alérgico a penicilina.
9. Eu não estou tomando nenhum medicamento no momento.
10. Com que frequência eu devo tomar isso?
11. Eu devo tomar isso com comida?
12. Você tem alguma coisa para dor de garganta?

WRITING PRACTICE 02

Write a symptom summary

Imagine you need to send a short message to a clinic before an appointment. Give clear information without writing a long story.

Task: Write 80-120 words describing how you feel. Mention your main symptoms, when they started, how strong they are, whether anything makes them better or worse, any allergies, and whether you are taking medication.

Try to include at least 6 of these:

- I have had...
- for / since
- It started...
- mild / moderate / severe
- gets worse
- allergy
- medication
- at the moment
- feel dizzy
- sore throat

Useful structure

My main problem is... / It started... / I have had... for... / The pain is... / It gets worse when... / I am / am not allergic to... / At the moment, I am taking...

Self-check before you finish

- ☐ Did I explain when the symptoms started?
- ☐ Did I describe the main symptoms clearly?
- ☐ Did I use for / since correctly?
- ☐ Did I mention allergies and medication if relevant?

CONVERSATION PRACTICE

Role-plays for the AI coach

Open the Conversation Lab and ask the AI to stay in character. Complete each situation before asking for corrections.

Role-play 1 · Doctor appointment

You have had a sore throat, cough, and headache for three days. Explain your symptoms, say when they started, answer questions about allergies and medication, and ask what you should do next.

Role-play 2 · Pharmacy visit

You need help for a headache and sore throat. Ask the pharmacist what over-the-counter options are available, how often to take the medicine, whether to take it with food, and what common side effects to know about.

Role-play 3 · Travelling while unwell

You are travelling and suddenly feel dizzy and nauseous. Ask a hotel receptionist or airport employee where you can find a clinic or pharmacy, explain your symptoms briefly, and ask for directions.

Conversation questions

- What health vocabulary is hardest for you to remember?
- Do you prefer explaining symptoms in detail or very directly?
- What information should you know before taking a new medicine?
- What would make a medical conversation in English easier for you?
- Why is it useful to know how to describe duration and intensity?

REVIEW

Mini test

Complete this without looking back. Check what is already automatic and what still needs another review.

1. Translate: dor de garganta = _____
2. Translate: tontura / tonto = _____
3. Complete: I have _____ a cough for three days.
4. Choose: I have felt tired for / since Monday.
5. Choose: I have had a headache for / since two hours.
6. Translate: receita médica = _____
7. Complete: take one _____ twice a day.
8. What does “side effect” mean?
9. Write one sentence with “allergy”.
10. Write one sentence with “gets worse”.
11. Translate: “Isso começou ontem à noite.”
12. Translate: “Eu não estou tomando nenhum medicamento no momento.”
13. Ask how often you should take a medicine.
14. Ask whether you should take a medicine with food.
15. Write a polite pharmacy question for a sore throat.

ANSWER KEY

Check and learn from your mistakes

Some answers can vary. The examples below show natural versions using the language taught in the lesson.

Quick practice - Vocabulary

- appointment
- tablet
- day
- Example: This medicine can cause a mild side effect.

Grammar mini practice

- had
- since
- for
- Example: I have had a sore throat since yesterday.

Writing practice 01 - Suggested answers

1. I do not feel very well.
2. I have a headache and a sore throat.
3. I have had a cough for three days.
4. I feel dizzy.
5. The pain gets worse at night.
6. It started yesterday morning.
7. I do not have any medication allergies. / I am not allergic to any medication.
8. I am allergic to penicillin.
9. I am not taking any medication at the moment.
10. How often should I take this?
11. Should I take this with food?
12. Do you have anything for a sore throat?

FINISH

Mini test answers + progress check

Use the score only as a guide. The real goal is to communicate clearly and understand the most common questions without translating every word.

1. sore throat
2. dizzy
3. had
4. since
5. for
6. prescription
7. tablet
8. An unwanted effect of a medicine.
- 9-10. Answers vary.
11. It started last night.
12. I am not taking any medication at the moment.
13. How often should I take this?
14. Should I take this with food?
15. Example: Do you have anything for a sore throat?

READY FOR CONVERSATION?

If you can do these four things, move to the Conversation Lab.

- ✓ Describe common symptoms clearly.
- ✓ Explain when symptoms started and how long they have lasted.
- ✓ Answer simple questions about allergies and medication.
- ✓ Ask basic questions at a pharmacy or clinic.

Next lesson suggestion: Work & Job Interviews